

D659

Assessing and Monitoring Student Learning

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A teacher gives a 10-question quiz on Tuesday. It is printed on bright green paper and takes about 12 minutes. That night she sorts the results and, on Wednesday, reteaches the step most students missed before moving on. How is the quiz being used?

- A. Formatively, because the results changed the next day's instruction.
- B. As a benchmark assessment, because it was given to the whole class.
- C. As neither, because it was too short to count.
- D. Summatively, because it was a graded quiz.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A unit test is given at the end of a unit, graded, and recorded, and the class moves to a new topic without any reteaching. Which change would turn the same test into a formative use?

- A. Give it before the unit ends and use the results to reteach missed skills.
- B. Stop recording the grade.
- C. Make it shorter.
- D. Add more multiple-choice items.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A science test on experimental design is written at a high reading level. Students who read well score high on it every time it is given, and scores are very consistent. The test was published by a large company and has a colorful answer sheet. What is the main problem?

- A. The test is valid because a large publisher created it.
- B. The test may be reliable but not valid for measuring experimental design.
- C. The test is unreliable because scores are consistent.
- D. The test is valid because the scores are reliable.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A family receives a report showing their child scored at the 70th percentile on a national reading test. The report came in a sealed envelope with a cover letter from the district office. What does this score mean?

- A. The child scored as well as or better than about 70% of students in the norm group.
- B. The child is 30% below grade level.
- C. The child answered 70% of the questions correctly.
- D. The child passed the state standard.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teacher wants to know whether each student can meet the grade-level standard for writing a claim with evidence, regardless of how classmates do. Which kind of assessment fits?

- A. A norm-referenced test that reports percentile ranks.
- B. A class ranking from highest to lowest.
- C. A criterion-referenced assessment scored against the standard.
- D. A grade curve so the average is a C.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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6.

A student in a reading intervention read 40 words correct per minute in week 1 and 56 in week 9 on weekly probes. The probes are given in the library before lunch. The goal requires growth of at least 1.5 words per week. What is the student's growth rate, and what does it suggest?

- A. About 1.8 words per week; the intervention should be changed.
- B. It cannot be judged because probes were given before lunch.
- C. 2.0 words per week; the student is on track, so continue the intervention.
- D. 16 words per week; the student has mastered reading.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student's weekly math probe scores are graphed. For the past five weeks, every point has fallen below the aim line and the trend is flat. What is the best decision?

- A.** Keep the plan and check again at the end of the year.
- B.** Change or intensify the intervention.
- C.** Stop monitoring because one more score could change everything.
- D.** Raise the goal because the student is doing well.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A student's persuasive essay has a clear claim but no evidence in the second paragraph. The student worked on it for a week and wrote it in blue ink. Which comment is the most effective feedback?

- A.** "Needs work."
- B.** "Your claim is clear. Paragraph 2 needs evidence—add a fact or quote that supports your reason."
- C.** "Great effort! B+."
- D.** "Nice job using blue ink and working hard all week."

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A team wants to find which parts of students' lab reports are weakest—hypothesis, data, or conclusion—so they can plan reteaching. The reports were typed in the computer lab and average four pages. Which scoring tool fits best?

- A.** A holistic rubric with one overall score.
- B.** A norm-referenced ranking of the reports.
- C.** A checklist of whether each report is four pages.
- D.** An analytic rubric with a separate score for each part.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A small group's scores on a unit quiz were 92, 88, 85, 84, 80, and 20. The student who scored 20 was absent for most of the unit. The quiz was given on a Friday. Which number best describes the typical score?

- A.** 85
- B.** The mean, about 74.8
- C.** 72, the range
- D.** The median, 84.5

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A class's median score is 78 and the mean is 86. What most likely explains the gap?

- A.** A few very low scores pulled the mean down.
- B.** The median counts every score, while the mean uses only the middle one.
- C.** The mean and median should always be equal, so there is an error.
- D.** A few very high scores pulled the mean above the median.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A teacher is sharing a student's reading progress at a family conference. The school has a new data dashboard with 14 metrics, and the meeting is scheduled for 20 minutes. What is the best way to present the data?

- A.** Walk through all 14 dashboard metrics so nothing is left out.
- B.** Read the technical score report aloud, including standard error terms.
- C.** Show a simple graph of the child's growth toward the goal, explain it in plain language, and share next steps.
- D.** Share only the class average so the child is not singled out.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

A teacher gives a 10-question quiz on Tuesday. ~~It is printed on bright green paper and takes about 12 minutes.~~ That night she sorts the results and, on Wednesday, reteaches the step most students missed before moving on. How is the quiz being used?

Target word: formative or summative **Decides:** Results were used to adjust instruction.

A	Correct	Use to adjust ongoing teaching defines formative assessment.
B	Adjacent category	Benchmarks are periodic, common checks across a school or district.
C	Camouflage	Length does not decide how an assessment is used.
D	Confusion set	Format and grading do not decide the type; use does.

2. Answer A Concept 1 • transfer

A unit test is given at the end of a unit, graded, and recorded, and the class moves to a new topic without any reteaching. Which change would turn the same test into a formative use?

Target word: reverse: make it formative **Decides:** Formative depends on using results to adjust learning.

A	Correct	Using results to guide instruction makes the use formative.
B	Adjacent category	Ungraded is not the same as formative if nothing is adjusted.
C	Dropped element	Length does not change how results are used.
D	Confusion set	Item format does not determine formative or summative use.

3. Answer B Concept 2

A science test on experimental design is written at a high reading level. Students who read well score high on it every time it is given, and scores are very consistent. ~~The test was published by a large company and has a colorful answer sheet.~~ What is the main problem?

Target word: validity vs. reliability **Decides:** Scores track reading, not experimental design.

A	Camouflage	Who made the test does not show what it measures.
B	Correct	Consistent results do not help if reading ability is what is being measured.
C	Inverted operation	Consistency is what reliability means.
D	Absolute language	Reliability is needed for validity but does not guarantee it.

4. Answer A Concept 3

A family receives a report showing their child scored at the 70th percentile on a national reading test. ~~The report came in a sealed envelope with a cover letter from the district office.~~ What does this score mean?

Target word: interpret a percentile rank **Decides:** Percentile compares with a norm group.

A	Correct	A percentile rank is a comparison with the norm group.
B	Inverted operation	Misreads the complement as a deficit.
C	Confusion set	Confuses percentile rank with percent correct.
D	Adjacent category	Passing a fixed standard is a criterion-referenced judgment.

5. Answer C Concept 3 • transfer

A teacher wants to know whether each student can meet the grade-level standard for writing a claim with evidence, regardless of how classmates do. Which kind of assessment fits?

Target word: reverse: pick the score type from the purpose **Decides:** Comparing to a fixed standard, not to peers.

A	Inverted operation	Norm-referenced results compare students to each other.
B	Adjacent category	Rankings are relative and say nothing about meeting the standard.
C	Correct	Criterion-referenced scores compare performance to a set standard.
D	Confusion set	Curving is norm-based and hides who met the standard.

6. Answer C Concept 4

A student in a reading intervention read 40 words correct per minute in week 1 and 56 in week 9 on weekly probes. ~~The probes are given in the library before lunch.~~ The goal requires growth of at least 1.5 words per week. What is the student's growth rate, and what does it suggest?

Target word: rate of growth vs. aim **Decides:** $(56 - 40) / 8 \text{ weeks} = 2.0 \text{ words per week}$.

A	Wrong stem number	Divides 16 by 9 probes instead of 8 intervals, and draws the wrong conclusion.
B	Camouflage	The testing time does not decide the growth rate.
C	Correct	16 words over 8 weeks = 2.0, above the 1.5 goal.
D	Dropped element	Drops the division by weeks.

7. Answer B Concept 4 • transfer

A student's weekly math probe scores are graphed. For the past five weeks, every point has fallen below the aim line and the trend is flat. What is the best decision?

Target word: decision rule from trend **Decides:** Consistent points below the aim line mean the plan is not working.

A	Dropped element	Ignores the data progress monitoring is meant to act on.
B	Correct	Data below the aim line over several points signal a needed change.
C	Absolute language	Five points form a trend; decisions should follow it.
D	Inverted operation	Raising the goal fits data above the aim line.

8. Answer B Concept 5

A student's persuasive essay has a clear claim but no evidence in the second paragraph. ~~The student worked on it for a week and wrote it in blue ink.~~ Which comment is the most effective feedback?

Target word: effective feedback **Decides:** Specific to the goal and gives a next step.

A	Adjacent category	Evaluative but not specific or actionable.
B	Correct	Specific, tied to the goal, and actionable.
C	Dropped element	Praise and a grade without a next step.
D	Camouflage	Comments on details that do not relate to the learning goal.

9. Answer D Concept 6

A team wants to find which parts of students' lab reports are weakest—hypothesis, data, or conclusion—so they can plan reteaching. ~~The reports were typed in the computer lab and average four pages.~~ Which scoring tool fits best?

Target word: rubric type from purpose **Decides:** Need scores for each part separately.

A	Confusion set	One score hides which part is weak.
B	Adjacent category	Ranking compares students but does not diagnose parts.
C	Camouflage	Length does not show skill quality.
D	Correct	Criterion-by-criterion scores show where the gaps are.

10. Answer D Concept 7

A small group's scores on a unit quiz were 92, 88, 85, 84, 80, and 20. The student who scored 20 was absent for most of the unit. ~~The quiz was given on a Friday.~~ Which number best describes the typical score?

Target word: typical score in a skewed set **Decides:** One extreme low score; median resists it.

A	Dropped element	Takes one middle score and drops averaging the middle pair.
B	Adjacent category	$449 / 6 = 74.8$ is dragged down by the score of 20.
C	Confusion set	$92 - 20 = 72$ measures spread, not the typical score.
D	Correct	Middle two scores 85 and 84 average to 84.5; the outlier does not pull it.

11. Answer D Concept 7 · transfer

A class's median score is 78 and the mean is 86. What most likely explains the gap?

Target word: reverse: infer the outlier from mean vs. median **Decides:** Mean above median means high scores pull it up.

A	Inverted operation	Low outliers would put the mean below the median.
B	Confusion set	Reverses the definitions.
C	Absolute language	They match only in symmetric data.
D	Correct	Outliers pull the mean toward them; here upward.

12. Answer C Concept 8

A teacher is sharing a student's reading progress at a family conference. ~~The school has a new data dashboard with 14 metrics, and the meeting is scheduled for 20 minutes.~~ What is the best way to present the data?

Target word: presenting data to families **Decides:** Match the display to the audience's question.

A	Camouflage	More data is not clearer; it buries the main message.
B	Adjacent category	Technical language suits specialists, not families.
C	Correct	Clear, audience-appropriate display focused on meaning for the child.
D	Dropped element	Drops the child's own data, which is what the family needs.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	6	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	1	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	8	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	5	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	3	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	7	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	6	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Formative vs. summative is about use	An assessment is formative when its results are used to adjust ongoing instruction; summative when it judges learning at the end of a period.	Deciding by format: quizzes are formative, tests are summative.	What the teacher does with the results.
2	Validity vs. reliability	Validity = the assessment measures what it claims to measure; reliability = it gives consistent results. Reliable does not mean valid.	Assuming a consistent test must be measuring the right thing.	Consistent scores on a test that measures the wrong skill.
3	Norm- vs. criterion-referenced scores	A percentile rank compares a student to a norm group; a criterion score compares performance to a fixed standard.	Reading the 70th percentile as 70% correct.	“Percentile” or “compared with a national sample.”
4	Progress monitoring and the aim line	Brief, repeated probes are graphed; the rate of growth is compared with the aim line to decide whether to change the intervention.	Judging an intervention from a single score.	Weekly probe scores and a goal date.
5	Effective feedback	Feedback works best when timely, specific to the goal, and tells the student what to do next.	Treating a grade or general praise as feedback.	Choices between comments on student work.
6	Analytic vs. holistic rubrics	Analytic rubrics score each criterion separately and show strengths and gaps; holistic rubrics give one overall score and are faster.	Using a holistic score when the goal is diagnosing specific skills.	A need to see which part of the work is weak.
7	Mean vs. median with outliers	An extreme score pulls the mean toward it; the median resists outliers and better describes the typical score in a skewed set.	Reporting the mean as the typical score when one score is extreme.	A list of scores with one far from the rest.
8	Presenting data to stakeholders	Match the display and language to the audience's question, and lead with what the data means for students.	Showing families the full raw data table with technical terms.	A named audience such as families or a school board.

Course scope (public description): Assessing and Monitoring Student Learning is a targeted course crafted for candidates who aim to enhance their skills in evaluating student progress and educational outcomes. This course provides an in-depth exploration of various assessment techniques, including formative and summative assessments, standardized tests, benchmark assessments, progress monitoring, and alternative assessment strategies. Participants will learn how to design effective assessment tools, interpret data to inform instruction, and provide meaningful feedback to students. This course also provides a foundation of data analysis that supports educators’ need to understand data and present data to stakeholders. Candidates will also explore online and digital assessment tools. Assessing and Monitoring Student Learning will prepare learners to align assessments to standards to monitor student learning, assess data, and provide on time and quality feedback.